The Philippine Procurement Board

An exhaustive read of every open government notice on both PhilGEPS systems — 22,068 notices, ₱207.1 billion of live contract value.

PyMC Labs · 9 August 2026

Ten numbers

22,068	OPEN NOTICES, BOTH SYSTEMS
₱207.1B	LIVE CONTRACT VALUE
0.863	GINI OF CONTRACT VALUE
80%	OF VALUE IN TOP 10% OF NOTICES
60.4%	CLOSE WITHIN SIX DAYS
62.1%	OF DEADLINES FALL MON OR TUE
4,860	DISTINCT PROCURING ENTITIES
6,839	DISTINCT FIRM ARCHETYPES
306×	NOTICES PRICED AT ₱4,950,000

> **The one-sentence version.** This is an enormous, atomised, fast-expiring market whose money is concentrated in a few hundred contracts, whose budgets are set by hand rather than costed, and whose official taxonomy cannot be trusted to find anything — which means the binding constraint on a bidder is not access to the data but the ability to be told, quickly, which four or five of 22,068 notices are theirs.

1 · The corpus

Two systems are live simultaneously, mid-migration. PS Advisory 2026-19 ended Executive-branch posting on legacy PhilGEPS 1.5 on 31 July 2026; non-Executive entities are on later batches and are still posting there. A given procuring entity posts to exactly one system at a time, so the two corpora are disjoint by construction — cross-searched in both directions, zero overlap.

System	Notices	Value	Median ABC
mPhilGEPS (modernised)	4,288	₱87.0B	₱2,000,000
Legacy PhilGEPS 1.5	17,780	₱120.0B	₱877,192
Total	**22,068**	**₱207.1B**	₱1,000,000

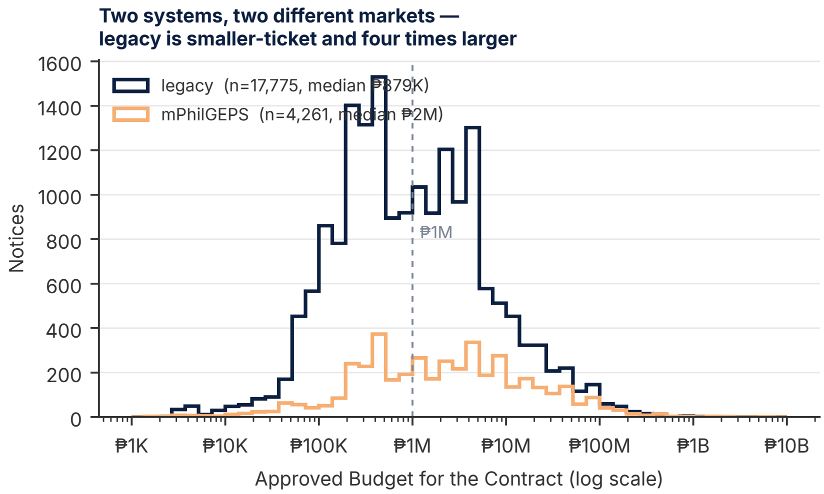
Legacy is 81% of the board and it is the part nobody scrapes. It is also a structurally different market: 73% public bidding against mPhilGEPS's 58% small-value procurement, and 36% civil works. The segment with real money is mostly in the corpus that every existing aggregator ignores.

ABC is present on 22,036 of 22,068 notices (99.9%). It is a labelled field on the detail page, not an inference — no language model is required to read it.

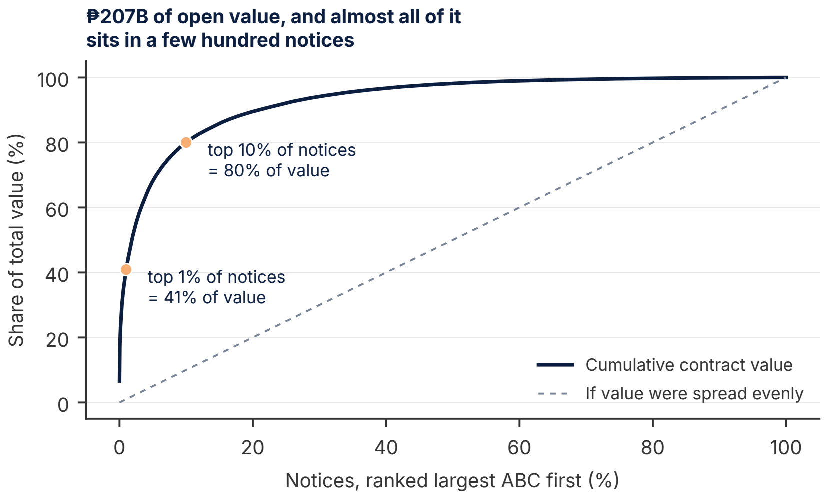
2 · The money is not where the notices are

The value distribution is close to pathological. A Gini of **0.863** puts contract value more unequally distributed than income in any country on earth.

Slice of notices	Share of notices	Share of value
Largest 1%	220 notices	**40.9%**
Largest 10%	2,204 notices	**80.0%**
Smallest 50%	11,034 notices	1.8%



Contract size by system, log scale. The distributions barely overlap in their centre of mass: legacy is a high-volume, small-ticket LGU market; mPhilGEPS skews to larger national contracts. Treating them as one pool averages away the distinction that matters.



Cumulative value against notices ranked by size. The curve's shape, not its level, is the finding.

Mean ABC is ₱9,396,029; median is ₱1,000,000. The mean sits at the 76th percentile — a nine-to-one ratio that says the average is describing a handful of contracts and nothing else. The 99th percentile is ₱121.2M and the largest single notice is ₱13.72B.

> **Consequence.** Any product decision framed as "serve contractors" is under-specified to the point of being wrong. The 11,034 notices below the median carry ₱3.7B between them — less than the top three notices combined. Volume and value are separate businesses with separate customers.

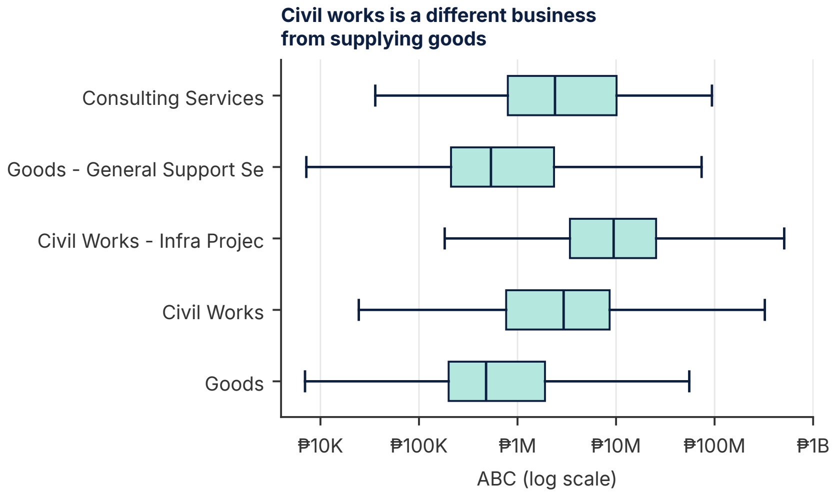
3 · Budgets are set by hand, and it shows

This section is the one a procurement economist would read first, and it is invisible in any aggregator that only lists notices.

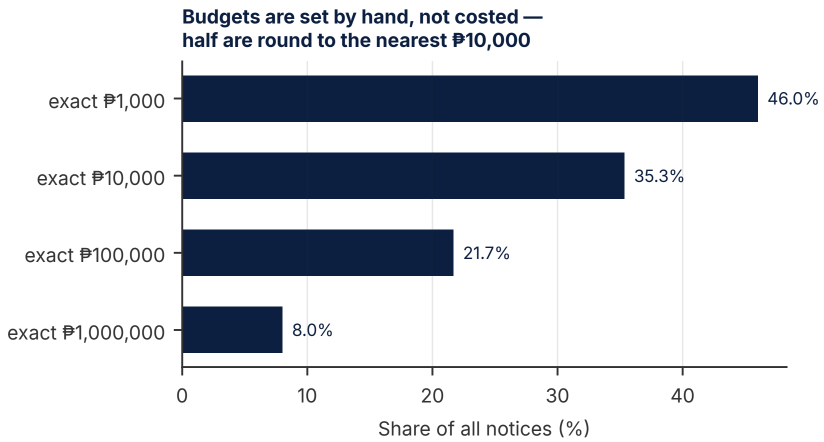
46.0% of all budgets are exact multiples of ₱1,000; 35.3% of ₱10,000; 21.7% of ₱100,000; 8.0% of a full ₱1,000,000. A costed estimate — quantities times unit prices plus contingency — does not land on a round million once in twelve times. These are figures chosen to fit an appropriation, then described as an estimate.

The four most common budgets in the corpus are ₱1,000,000 (341 notices), ₱500,000 (316), **₱4,950,000 (306)**, and ₱100,000 (299).

That third value is the interesting one, and it motivates a formal test.

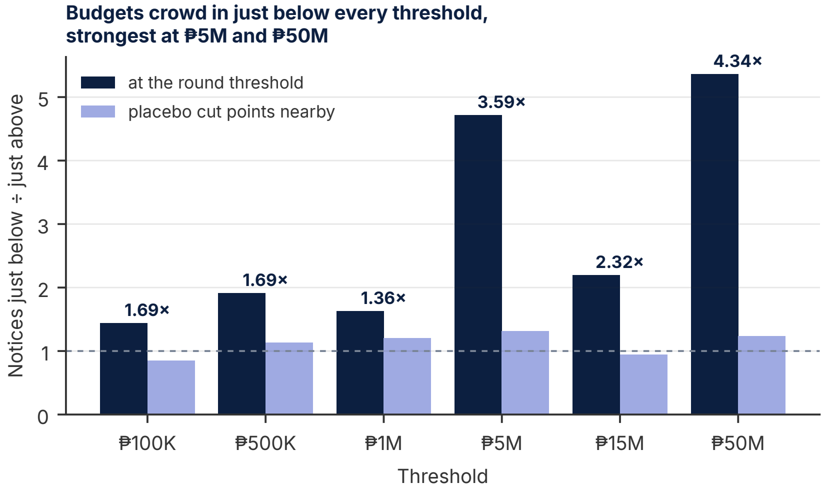


Contract size by official classification. Civil works and infrastructure together are 8,082 notices — 37% of the board — but ₱136.4B, or 66% of all value.



Share of budgets that are exact multiples of each round figure.

A raw below-versus-above count proves nothing: small contracts are more common than large ones, so **any** cut point in a decaying distribution has more mass beneath it. Two corrections are needed. First, exact-threshold notices are excluded from both bins — with 8% of budgets landing on an exact million, leaving them in the upper bin manufactures fake anti-bunching at precisely the round numbers under test. Second, each threshold is compared against placebo cut points of similar magnitude but no procedural significance.



Notices just below each threshold divided by notices just above, against placebo cut points at 1.3×, 1.7× and 2.3× the same threshold. Ratios above the placebo indicate genuine crowding rather than the ordinary downward slope of the size distribution.

Threshold	Below ÷ above	Placebo	Excess
₱100K	1.44	0.85	1.69×
₱500K	1.91	1.13	1.69×
₱1M	1.63	1.20	1.36×
₱5M	4.71	1.31	**3.59×**
₱15M	2.19	0.95	2.32×
₱50M	5.36	1.24	**4.34×**

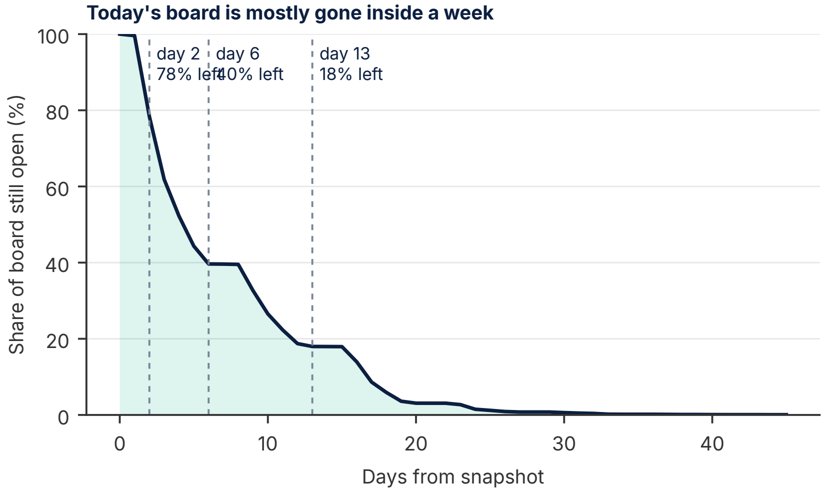
Every threshold shows excess crowding just beneath it, and the effect strengthens with contract size — 3.59× at ₱5M and 4.34× at ₱50M. Combined with 306 notices priced at ₱4,950,000, exactly 1% under the ₱5M line, the pattern is consistent with budgets being written to stay under procedural thresholds rather than to reflect the cost of the work.

> **Read this claim narrowly.** Bunching below a threshold is what contract-splitting looks like in aggregate data, but it is equally what a well-understood budget ceiling looks like when an agency scopes work to fit it. This analysis cannot separate the two, and nothing here identifies any individual notice as improper. What it does establish is that **thresholds, not costs, are shaping the numbers** — which is a fact about how to search this market, whatever its cause.

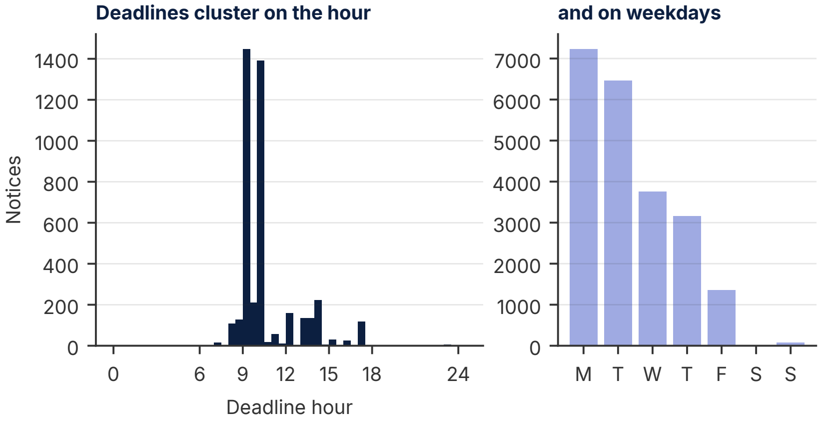
4 · Everything expires, and it expires on Monday

21.6% of the board closes within 48 hours and 60.4% within six days. Median remaining life is 4.4 days. The stock figure of "22,068 open opportunities" is therefore misleading as a measure of what is actionable: two-thirds of it is gone before a weekly reviewer looks again.

Against that, inflow is relentless. Measuring it needs care: publish dates are only observable for notices **still open**, so anything published three weeks ago and already closed is invisible, and any average over a trailing window is biased downwards. Two unbiased routes agree. Little's law on the stock and the mean 16-day notice lifetime gives **≈1,380 arrivals and departures per day**. The freshest, uncensored days confirm it directly.



Share of the snapshot still open, by day. Median remaining life is 4.4 days.



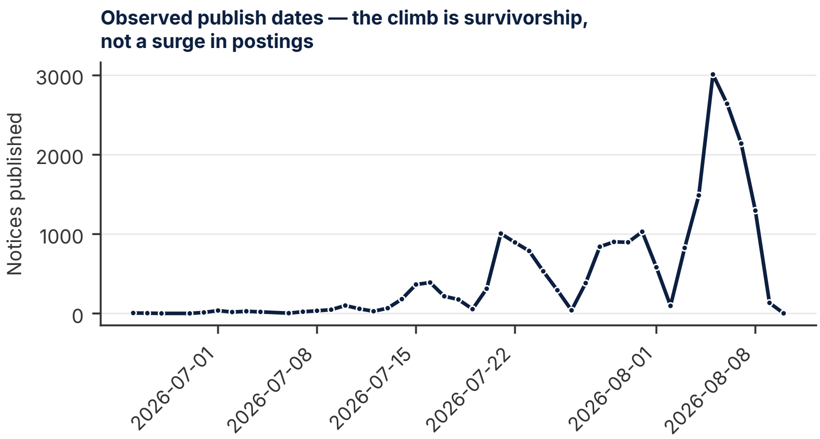
Submission deadlines by hour (mPhilGEPS, where a time is recorded) and by weekday (both systems). Legacy records dates without times, so the clock panel is mPhilGEPS only.

Date	Published	Closing
Mon 3 Aug	826	—
Tue 4 Aug	1,488	—
Wed 5 Aug	3,012	—
Thu 6 Aug	2,642	—
Fri 7 Aug	2,141	—
Mon 10 Aug	—	**4,692**
Tue 11 Aug	—	3,647
Wed 12 Aug	—	2,128

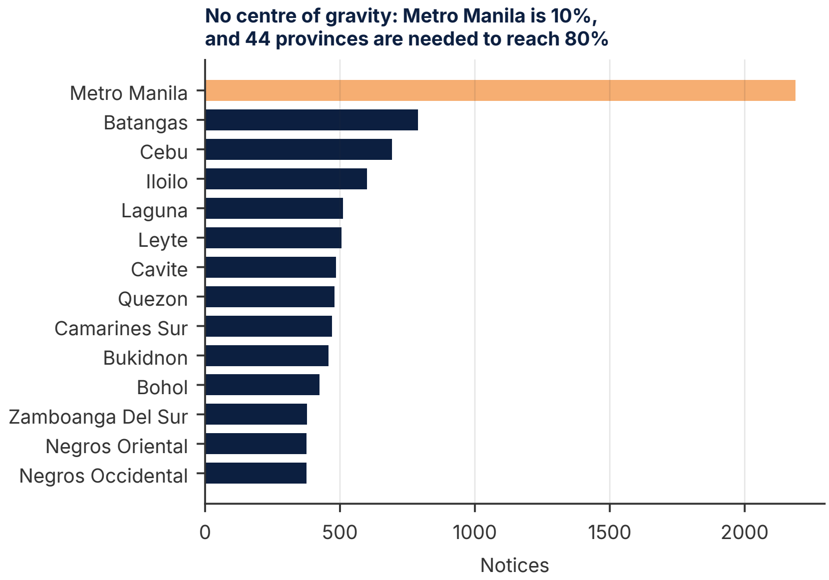
The worst single day is a Monday: 4,692 notices expire at once, 21% of the whole board, and 13,326 expire inside seven days. Peak observed publication was 3,012 in one day. So the steady-state pipeline is roughly **1,500–3,000 detail fetches to ingest and 1,000–4,700 rows to expire per working day** — an order of magnitude more churn than the stock figure suggests, and the reason a weekly cadence cannot work.

Two operational facts fall out, and neither is in any competitor's product:

- **Deadlines are a morning event.** 1,619 notices close at 10:00 and 1,452 at 09:00 — together more than four times the 14:00 count. A submission that is not lodged before mid-morning is late.
- **Deadlines are a Monday–Tuesday event.** Monday takes 7,233 closings and Tuesday 6,467 — **62.1% of the entire board across two days** — against just 1,355 on Friday. The real preparation deadline is therefore the preceding Friday afternoon, and the weekend is the crunch.



Publish dates of notices **that are still open**. The upward climb is not rising activity — it is right-censoring: notices published weeks ago have already closed and left the corpus. Only the last few days are unbiased, which is why inflow is estimated from those and from Little's law.



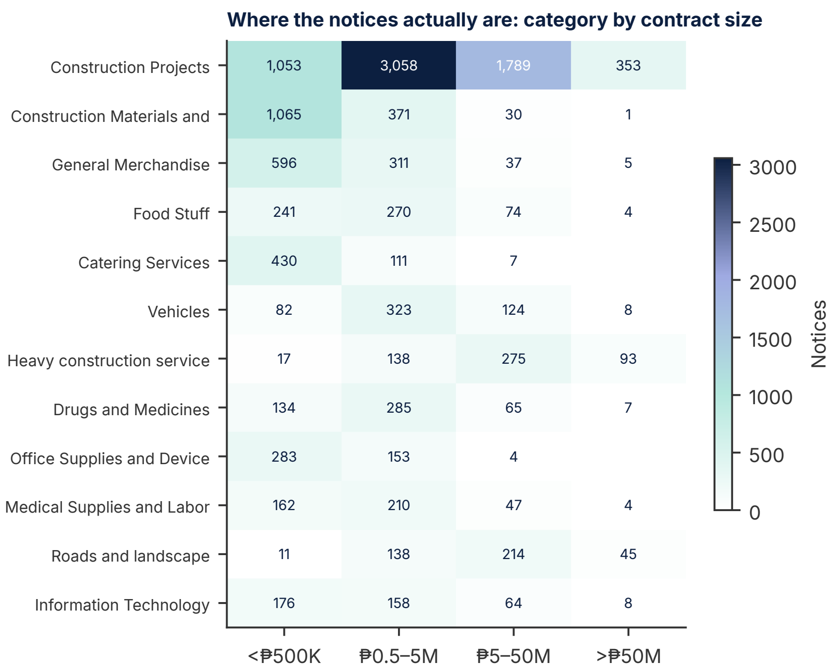
Notices by delivery location. Metro Manila, highlighted, is under a tenth of the board.

5 · There is no centre of gravity

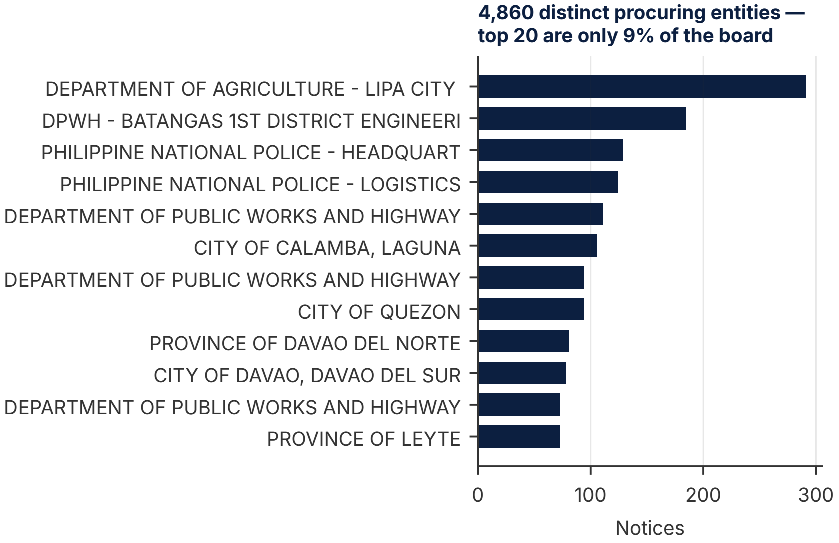
Metro Manila accounts for 2,187 notices — 9.9%. Reaching 80% of the corpus requires **44** separate provinces. Batangas (788), Cebu (693), Iloilo (599), Laguna (510) and Leyte (505) each carry a real share, and the tail is long and thin.

A capital-city product covers a tenth of this market. The dispersion also explains why the procurement graveyard is littered with projects that indexed the national portal and stopped: the work is in the provinces, and the provinces are the part that is tedious to normalise.

Delivery location is missing entirely on 8.7% of notices — genuinely blank on the source page, not a parsing failure. Any geographic filter must therefore decide what to do with one notice in eleven, and silently dropping them is the wrong answer.



Top twelve business categories by contract size band. Construction and its supply chain dominate both the count and the value.



The twelve largest procuring entities. Note the axis: the largest is under 300 notices.

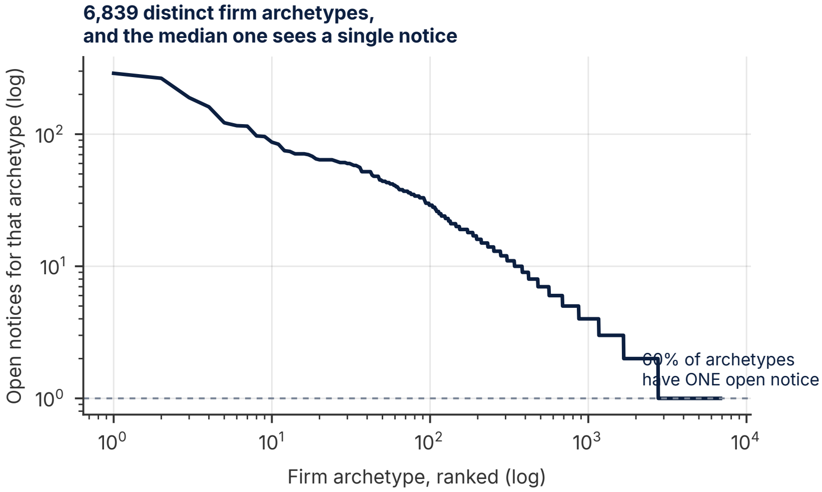
6 · The demand side is atomised

Construction Projects alone is 6,253 notices (28.3%); adding Construction Materials and Supplies (1,467) and heavy construction services puts construction and its supply chain near 40% of the board. Consulting Services is 179 notices — 0.8%. Titles containing the word "software" number **44**, or 0.2%.

4,860 distinct procuring entities publish to these systems, and the twenty largest account for only 8.9% of the board. 46.5% of entities have published exactly one open notice. There is no dominant buyer to build a relationship with — not even DPWH, whose largest single district office contributes 185 notices, or 0.8%.

By tier: municipalities 5,822 notices, barangays 3,690, cities 3,171, provinces 1,883, national departments 3,569. **Local government accounts for roughly two-thirds of the board**, down to individual barangays.

Defining a firm archetype as category × size band × province yields **6,839** distinct archetypes. The largest — general merchandise, micro, Metro Manila — has 289 open notices. **The median archetype has exactly one, and 59.7% have exactly one.** Reaching half the board takes 504 archetypes.



Notices per firm archetype, defined as category × size band × province, log–log. The distribution is close to a power law over three decades.

> **The churn mechanism.** A precisely profiled firm sees single digits per session, which validates aggressive curation — but the median archetype sees roughly one notice every ten days. Serve a narrow profile literally and the user opens an empty feed most mornings and leaves. Deliberate widening — adjacent provinces, adjacent categories, lot-level decomposition of multi-lot notices — is not a nice-to-have; it is what keeps the product from appearing broken.

7 · What the data says

1. **Pick volume or value; they are different companies.** 11,034 notices below the median carry 1.8% of the money. 2,204 notices carry 80% of it. The first is a high-churn, low-price, many-user business; the second is a few hundred firms for whom one missed bid dwarfs a decade of subscription fees.
2. **The official taxonomy cannot be the filter.** Category is self-declared by the buyer and wrong often enough to matter — notices filed as Goods that are civil works, one filed as Consulting Services that is a printing job. Classification is a hint, not a key.
3. **Daily cadence is not a feature choice, it is arithmetic.** 60.4% six-day expiry against 583 new notices a weekday means a weekly reviewer structurally misses most of the market.
4. **Friday afternoon is the real deadline.** 62.1% of closings are Monday or Tuesday morning. A product that surfaces a Monday 09:00 deadline on Monday at 08:00 is worthless.
5. **The provinces are the product.** Metro Manila is 9.9%; 44 provinces are needed for 80%; two-thirds of notices come from LGUs down to barangay level. A normalised local-government registry is the asset here, and it is built by labour, not by cleverness.
6. **Thresholds shape the numbers, so search must be threshold-aware.** Excess mass sits below every procedural line, most sharply at ₱5M and ₱50M, and ₱4,950,000 recurs 306 times. A firm whose capacity straddles ₱5M should be shown both sides of that line explicitly.
7. **Software is not a market here.** 44 notices in 22,068. Construction and supply are the market.

8 · Method, and what would move these numbers

Both systems were enumerated in full rather than sampled — 215 listing pages plus 4,288 detail fetches on mPhilGEPS, 893 pager offsets plus 17,780 detail fetches on legacy — on 8–9 August 2026. Detail fields are parsed as labelled key–value structure, never by line adjacency: an adjacency parser silently wrote the **following field's label** into any empty field, corrupting delivery location on 13% of notices while reporting a 100% capture rate. Days-to-close is measured against a fixed reference of 9 August 2026.

Four caveats bound everything above.

- **Snapshot, not panel.** Every figure describes the board on one day. Lead-time and inflow statistics are stable in shape, but composition shifts with the migration between systems.

- **Business category is self-declared** and, per a 337-notice model-tagged audit, materially wrong in a low single-digit percentage of cases. Category-level counts are indicative.
- **Bunching is a pattern, not a finding about any notice.** Contract splitting and honest scoping-to-budget are observationally identical in this data.
- **The deepest text is untouched.** Attached bid documents and supplements — present on every detail page examined — were not fetched. Notice descriptions are largely boilerplate; the real scope lives in the attachments, and no competitor surfaces them either.